

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical property law, disputes and in-house legal experience. Completed a year-long placement at BCLP spanning real estate disputes and international arbitration, gaining direct experience in document management, hearing bundle preparation, court filings and deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters. Also holds in-house contract review experience from an Adobe legal internship. Currently advising clients at Citizens Advice across a wide range of matters, managing case files and correspondence to tight deadlines. Organised, detail-focused and comfortable supporting senior stakeholders in fast-moving commercial environments.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across multiple concurrent property matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records via iManage; handled court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines, keeping records accurate and up to date throughout

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial on a complex investment arbitration; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages a varied caseload from first client interview to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets external deadlines
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across housing, employment, welfare benefits, debt and consumer matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and next steps; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for people who are often unfamiliar with formal legal processes

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Supported acceptance of standard contractual terms: reviewed documentation, flagged provisions needing legal input and communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including risks around children's personal data and adtech
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems; legal and commercial research; concise report and correspondence writing**Case and evidence management:** Hearing bundle preparation, document review and organisation, procedural histories, deadline tracking, matter file maintenance, compliance documentation